

Political Theory Grad Course Offerings and Subfield Requirements – Last Updated August 2025

Courses

PLSC 5090a. Philosophy of Science for the Study of Politics. Ian Shapiro
PLSC 5530a. Social Justice. Bruce Ackerman
PLSC 5680b. Democracy in Weimar: Creativity, Crisis, & Revolution. Lucia Rubinelli
PLSC 5710a. Designing and Reforming Democracy. David Froomkin and Ian Shapiro
PLSC 5780a. What is the University?. Mordechai Levy-Eichel
PLSC 5790a. Rousseau's Emile. Bryan Garsten
PLSC 5810a. Socialism and Democracy, 1820-1940. Lucia Rubinelli
PLSC 5820a. Politics and the Passions. Giulia Oskian
PLSC 5900a. Introduction to Advanced Politics Theory. Ian Shapiro
PLSC 5970a. Lincoln's Statecraft and Rhetoric. Steven Smith
PLSC 6020a. Political Epistemology: On Knowledge and Belief in Politics. Helene Landemore
PLSC 6110b. Recent Work on Justice. Thomas Pogge
PLSC 6170b. Democracy and Deliberation. Helene Landemore
PLSC 6230a. Rethinking the Political Enlightenment. Ian Shapiro
PLSC 6235a. Genealogies of the Modern State. Nazmul Sultan.
PLSC 6270a. Aristotle's Political Thought. Bryan Garsten
PLSC 6380b. Political Philosophy in a Time of Crisis: Strauss, Berlin, Oakeshott, and Aron. Steven Smith
PLSC 6400a. Advanced Topics in Modern Political Philosophy. Giulia Oskian and Isaac Nakhimovsky
PLSC 6440b. The Idea of Statesmanship. Steven Smith
PLSC 6450a. Machiavelli and Machiavellianism. Steven Smith
PLSC 6460b. Open Democracy: Reinventing Popular Rule for the Twenty-First Century. Helene Landemore
PLSC 6720a. Edwin Burke and the Age of Empire. David Bromwich
PLSC 7090b. Comparative Constitutional Law. Bruce Ackerman
PLSC 8590b. Reconstructing the American Constitution. Bruce Ackerman

Workshops

PLSC 9340a/9350b. Political Theory Workshop. (Various Instructors).

Note:

-a courses are offered in the Fall, b courses are offered in the Spring. ab courses are offered in the Fall and Spring. a/b courses are offered in the Fall or Spring.

Subfield Requirements

Students may qualify in Political Theory by exam or coursework.

For the exam option, students must take two courses in PT plus the exam.

For the coursework option, students must take three courses in PT and they must write a PT paper, in the context of a PT course, that shows a strong command of the substantive and methodological approaches in the field.

For the BA/MA program, any PT course may be considered a “core” course.